

Read these lines and answer the questions that follow.

a. "All of the sights of the hill and the plain
Fly as thick as driving rain."

i. List five sights that the poet has mentioned in the poem.

Answer: Hedges and ditches, river, painted stations, meadows with horses and cattle, bridges and houses.

ii. Why did the poet compare the things he saw to 'driving rain'?

Answer: The poet compared them to driving rain because he could see them only for a moment before they quickly disappeared from sight.

iii. Briefly explain the poetic device used in these lines to bring about a comparison.

Answer: The poetic device is simile. The speed of the train is compared to the speed of driving rain.

b. "And ever again, in the wink of an eye,
Painted stations whistle by."

i. In your own words, give the meaning of 'in the wink of an eye'.

Answer: It means very quickly or in a flash.

ii. What is actually whistling by? What is not moving?

Answer: The train is actually whistling by. The station is not moving.

iii. After these lines, the poet described three people whom he saw. Who were they?

Answer: A child, a tramp, and a man in a cart.

3. List all the words in the poem that describe movement.

Answer: Charging, fly, clambers, scrambles, run away, lumping

4. To show the speed of the train, the poet said that the things he saw were speeding by. Were these things really speeding? What do you think of this idea?

Answer: No, the things were not really speeding. It was the train that was moving fast, making it seem as if the surroundings were moving.

5. What does "each a glimpse and gone for ever" mean? How do you think the poet felt as he wrote this line?

Answer: It means that everything is seen only for a moment before disappearing from sight forever. The poet felt slightly nostalgic as he described these passing scenes.

MCQs – From a Railway Carriage (Make Connections)

1. What is the correct sequence of things mentioned in the poem?

- A. Stations, a child, a cart, a mill, a river
- B. A child, stations, a river, a mill, a cart
- C. A cart, stations, a child, a mill, a river
- D. Stations, a child, a river, a cart, a mill

2. The poet compares the passing sights to:
 - A. Falling leaves
 - B. Driving rain
 - C. Flying birds
 - D. Flowing water
3. Which poetic device is used in the line "Fly as thick as driving rain"?
 - A. Metaphor
 - B. Personification
 - C. Simile
 - D. Alliteration
4. "In the wink of an eye" means:
 - A. Slowly
 - B. Suddenly
 - C. Very quickly
 - D. Carefully
5. What is actually whistling by?
 - A. The station
 - B. The river
 - C. The train
 - D. The houses
6. Which three people are mentioned by the poet?
 - A. A child, a tramp, and a man in a cart
 - B. A farmer, a child, and a woman
 - C. A boy, a soldier, and a driver
 - D. A child, a teacher, and a sailor
7. Which of these is NOT mentioned in the poem?
 - A. Painted stations
 - B. Meadows with horses and cattle
 - C. A marketplace
 - D. Bridges and houses
8. The poem mainly describes:
 - A. A sea voyage
 - B. A fast train journey
 - C. A walk in the forest
 - D. A mountain